ONBRD-99: Best Practice Summary

> **Series:** ONBRD — Dynatrace Onboarding | **Reference:** 99 — Best Practice Summary | **Created:** March 2026 | **Last Updated:** 11/10/2026

Overview

Reference card for an architect or tenant lead onboarding a new 2026 Dynatrace tenant: recommended defaults, the key decision matrix, validation queries, anti-patterns, and the cross-series next-steps map.

For the **sequence + dependencies + per-step decisions**, see **ONBRD-00: Architect's Sequence & Dependency Runbook**.

Table of Contents

1. Recommended Defaults (2026)
2. Decision Matrix
3. Validation Queries
4. Anti-Patterns to Avoid
5. Where to Go Deeper — Topic Series Map

Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Audience	Architect or tenant lead onboarding a new 2026 Dynatrace tenant

Requirement	Details
Used alongside	**ONBRD-00: Architect's Sequence & Dependency Runbook** for sequence + dependencies

1. Recommended Defaults (2026)

A new 2026 tenant should default to these choices unless there is a specific reason not to.

Area	Default	Why
API token	**Platform Token** (`dt0s16`) with `Authorization: Bearer`	Latest environments have platform tokens only: *"Classic access tokens don't exist in latest environments, and v2/apiTokens isn't available."* Classic access tokens (`dt0c01` , `Authorization: Api-Token`) exist only in Classic and hybrid environments.
Configuration	**Settings v2** / Configuration as Code (Terraform `dynatrace_settings` , Monaco v2)	SaaS 1.337: *"Many Configuration API endpoints are now covered by the Settings endpoints in the Environment API v2."* The affected Configuration API endpoints are deprecated. Plan automation around Settings v2.
Extensions	**Extensions 2.0**	Current extensions framework; EF1.0 end of support 2025-03-31. JMX and PMI EF1 extensions were kept past that date but are deprecated: *"As of July 1, 2027, all Extension Framework 1.0 JMX and PMI extensions will be out of support for SaaS Environments."* Migrate them during onboarding.

Area	Default	Why
Tagging at source	**Primary fields/tags at OneAgent install** via `oneagentctl --set-host-tag="primary_tags.<key>=<value>"` and `--set-host-tag="dt.security_context=<value>"` (single tags-hub form, June 2026; prefix written explicitly)	OneAgent attribute enrichment (OneAgent 1.333+) emits these on every signal at ingest.
Boundary field	**`dt.security_context`** for data + IAM scoping	Gen3 standard; segments + this field replace legacy Management Zones.
IAM policies	**Parameterized policies** bound to groups via binding parameters	Avoids N-copies-of-similar-policy maintenance burden.
K8s deployment	**Dynatrace Operator + Cloud Native FullStack**	*"Classic Full-Stack mode is not supported when using a platform token"*, the default credential above; ONBRD-05 covers the mode choice.
K8s CRD baseline	**DynaKube `v1beta6`** for new DynaKubes	Operator 1.11.0 removes `v1beta4` and says *"Before upgrading, update all DynaKube manifests to v1beta6."* `v1beta5` is still served by 1.11.0 but marked deprecated in its CRD (ONBRD-05).
Alerting	**Workflows** (simple workflows for notification) + **custom alerts** for metric conditions	Alerting profiles and problem notifications are Dynatrace Classic: *"They continue to work and are not being removed on a published schedule, but they'll not receive new capabilities."* Build new alerting on workflows (ONBRD-09).
Logs	**OpenPipeline**	The Latest Dynatrace path for log processing; OPMIG covers moving off classic log processing, OPLOGS the pipelines themselves.

Area	Default	Why
Windows OneAgent	**Npcap** for network insight (OneAgent 1.337+)	Required for Network Agent metrics; WinPcap is no longer supported.

> **Sources:**
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> - Authentication (DT docs) — *"dt0s16 Platform Token enabling programmatic access to Dynatrace platform services."*; Upgrade from classic access tokens (DT docs)
> - SaaS 1.337 (DT docs)
> - EF1 JMX and PMI extensions end of support (DT docs); End-of-support news (DT docs) — *"Note that JMX and PMI Extensions Framework 1.0 are supported past March 2025 but are deprecated."*
> - Classic Full-Stack monitoring (DT docs); Operator 1.11.0 release notes (DT docs); `v1beta5` `deprecated: true` read from the DynaKube CRD in the Operator v1.11.0 `kubernetes.yaml` (Operator releases (Dynatrace GitHub)), 10/02/2026
> - Upgrade guide: alert notifications (DT docs)

2. Decision Matrix

Decisions an architect makes during onboarding, with default and when to deviate.

Decision	Default	When to deviate
ActiveGate yes/no	Recommended if >500 hosts (ONBRD-03); needed for hybrid/on-prem or cloud-API polling at scale	Pure SaaS-only with no on-prem footprint can defer until cloud-API polling demands it
ActiveGate sizing	At least 8 GB **disk** per ActiveGate, about 12.5 GB with extensions (ONBRD-03); CPU and memory per FAQ-10; 2–3 AGs per network zone	Larger only when load testing shows it is needed

Decision	Default	When to deviate
Per-cloud integration	**Clouds app** for AWS (GA) and Azure (SaaS 1.337+, no AG for metric polling); GCP Clouds-app connection generally available (10/29/2026) — verify it has reached your tenant; the classic GCP integration (`dynatrace-gcp-monitor` on GKE, no ActiveGate on SaaS) remains the working path until then	If existing CloudWatch / Azure Monitor pipelines exist, evaluate migration effort vs leaving in place
OneAgent rollout sequence	Pilot 2–5 non-critical hosts (ONBRD-05) → expand by host group → full	Skip pilot if you have onboarded the same workload class on another tenant
Tag taxonomy	env / team / app / `dt.security_context` / `dt.cost.costcenter`	Add compliance dimensions (`*-pci` , `*-pii`) only if a hard audit boundary exists
Host group naming	`<env>-<app>` or `<env>-<workload-type>` per FAQ-01	Customer-specific patterns acceptable; avoid `all-hosts` / `default` / hardware-trait names
Bucket strategy	`dt.security_context` for general data access; **buckets only for compliance / retention / hard cost / hostile multi-tenancy**	See ORGNZ-02 (Grail buckets) and ORGNZ-99 for the buckets-vs-`dt.security_context` decision
OTel coexistence	OneAgent for instrumentation; OTel for app-code spans / business events / serverless	Per FAQ-03 OneAgent and OpenTelemetry decision framework
Workflow trigger	Problem trigger (default); Event trigger with a DQL filter (advanced)	Custom DQL triggers when business-event-driven alerting is required
Dashboard tier	Operations + Executive (mandatory); Engineering (recommended)	Skip Executive if there is no exec stakeholder for this tenant

Decision	Default	When to deviate
Notification channel for new tenant	Slack / email / PagerDuty silent channel for first 1–2 weeks	Switch to live channels only after dual-alert window validates volume parity

3. Validation Queries

A small DQL set that verifies each phase complete. Save these as a notebook in the new tenant — they are the architect's smoke-test for the deployment.

Phase 1 — Foundation complete

Hosts reporting (Gate G1):

```
// Hosts reporting (Gate G1 — Foundation -&gt; Organize)
smartscapeNodes "HOST"
| summarize host_count = count()

// Caveat: Smartscape HOST nodes can leave out PaaS-only hosts. On a
validation tenant
// (10/02/2026) this returned 7 while fetch dt.entity.host returned 15; the 8
missing were
// Kubernetes application-only and AWS Fargate hosts (paasVendorType
KUBERNETES /
// AWS_ECS_FARGATE). For those rollouts, count with the classic entity
instead:
//   fetch dt.entity.host
//   | summarize host_count = count(), by: {paasVendorType}
```

```
// Services discovered
smartscapeNodes "SERVICE"
| summarize service_count = count()
```

Phase 2 — Organize complete

Primary fields propagating; `dt.security_context` populated (Gate G2):

```
// dt.security_context populated on logs (Gate G2 — Organize -&gt; Operate)
fetch logs, from:-1h
| summarize { c = count() }, by:{dt.security_context}
| sort c desc
```

```
// Primary tags propagating
fetch logs, from:-1h
| filter isNotNull(primary_tags.environment)
| summarize { c = count() }, by:{primary_tags.environment}
```

Phase 3 — Operate complete

Davis surfacing problems, and workflows running:

```
// Davis problems detected (last 7 days)
fetch dt.davis.problems, from:-7d
| summarize { c = count() }, by:{event.status}
```

```
// Workflow runs by final state (last 7 days)
// Each run also writes a RUNNING record when it starts; filter to final
states to count runs once
fetch dt.system.events, from:-7d
| filter event.kind == "WORKFLOW_EVENT" and event.type == "WORKFLOW_EXECUTION"
| filter in(dt.automation_engine.state, {"SUCCESS", "ERROR"})
| summarize { runs = count() }, by:{dt.automation_engine.workflow.title,
dt.automation_engine.state}
| sort runs desc
```

4. Anti-Patterns to Avoid

Anti-pattern	Why it bites later
Single host group (`all-hosts` / `default`)	Per-host-group thresholds, alerting profiles, and IAM policies become impossible to scope
Setting tags retroactively (after install)	Primary-tag-at-install propagation gets skipped; signals before the retroactive setting do not carry the tag

Anti-pattern	Why it bites later
Many copies of similar IAM policies (one per group with hardcoded scope)	Maintenance grows with org churn; use parameterized policies bound via binding parameters
Legacy Management Zones for new tenant	API 1.337 marks the `managementZone` (and `serviceTag`) properties of calculated service metrics deprecated; segments + `dt.security_context` + policies are the Latest Dynatrace path (MZ2POL)
Auto-tagging rules as the primary tagging strategy	Applied to entities by periodic background rule evaluation, which can lag (*"the application of all tags might be delayed!"*), not written onto records at ingest; doesn't propagate to logs / business events uniformly
`fetch dt.entity.*` queries in new content	Modern path is `smartscapeNodes "<TYPE>"`; `dt.entity.*` works but is deprecated
Buckets used as the primary access-control mechanism	Buckets are for compliance / retention / hard cost / hostile multi-tenancy; default for general data access is `dt.security_context`
Classic FullStack on Kubernetes	Not supported with platform tokens; use Cloud Native FullStack
Configuration API for new automation	Many Configuration API endpoints are deprecated in favour of Settings (SaaS 1.337); plan new pipelines on Settings v2 / Terraform / Monaco v2
Naming host groups by hardware traits (`4cpu-hosts`, `region-only`)	Encodes properties that change; rename burden as workloads scale

> **Sources:** Dynatrace API 1.337 (DT docs) — `POST /calculatedMetrics/service`: *"Changed property managementZone Deprecated changed to true"*; Settings API: automatically applied tags schema (DT docs) — *"Tagging rules are executed periodically in the background, for a limited timeframe."*; Classic Full-Stack monitoring (DT docs); SaaS 1.337 (DT docs).

5. Where to Go Deeper — Topic Series Map

ONBRD covers the foundation. These topic series cover each domain in depth:

Domain	Topic Series	Notebooks
IAM administration	IAM	15
Data organization (buckets, segments, security context)	ORGNZ	11
Frequently asked questions	FAQ	growing collection
OpenPipeline log processing	OPLOGS	9
Classic Logs → OpenPipeline migration	OPMIG	10
OpenPipeline beyond logs (spans, metrics, events, bizevents)	OPIPE	7
Distributed tracing & spans	SPANS	9
Kubernetes monitoring & DynaKube	K8S	15
Cloud integration deep dives (AWS, Azure, GCP)	CLOUD	9
OpenTelemetry integration	OTEL	9
Workflows & alert notifications	WFLOW	12
Alerting strategy & design	ALERT	5
Service level objectives	SLO	6
Dynatrace Intelligence (Causal/Predictive/Generative AI, Davis)	AIOPS	8
Dashboard strategy & executive reporting	DASH	8
Configuration automation & GitOps	AUTOM	14
Management Zone → Policy migration	MZ2POL	11
Web Real User Monitoring	WEBRUM	10
Native mobile monitoring	MOBL	13

Domain	Topic Series	Notebooks
Synthetic monitoring	SYNTH	7
Business events & funnel analytics	BIZEV	8
Database monitoring	DBMON	7
Application security	APPSEC	10
Cost management & FinOps	FINOPS	3
Platform maturity & adoption roadmap	ADOPT	7
Running Dynatrace Managed	DTM	14
Managed → SaaS migration	M2S	11
SaaS → SaaS migration	S2S	12
New Relic → Dynatrace (procedural runbook)	NR2DT	11
New Relic → Dynatrace (component deep dives)	NRLC	9
Sumo Logic → Dynatrace	SL2DT	11
Splunk → Dynatrace	S2D	10

This notebook was AI-generated from community-submitted and publicly available sources. This notebook series is not officially supported by Dynatrace. Always verify information against the current Dynatrace documentation.